

Equal Opportunity and Diversity Regulation — Regulation Document

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This regulation document gives effect to Equal Opportunity and Diversity Regulation and covers the purposes, responsibilities and operating expectations associated with Equality. It should be read alongside supporting guidance and any subsequent circulars.

Background and Rationale

Following sustained engagement with universities, colleges and sector bodies, University Administration has prepared this regulation document to give effect to Equality, Diversity. It builds on earlier guidance while updating expectations to reflect current conditions.

The regulation landscape has evolved considerably in recent years, and institutions under University Administration have responded with renewed attention to Equality, Diversity, Anti-Discrimination. This regulation document provides the framework needed to guide consistent practice across the sector.

Purpose

The purpose of this document is to establish a consistent basis for Equality, Diversity across University Administration-affiliated institutions, to clarify responsibilities, and to define the outcomes expected of every stakeholder.

By setting out the rationale, scope and operating expectations for Equality, the document aims to reduce ambiguity, support institutional planning and improve the quality of Diversity across the system.

Policy Objectives

In pursuing these objectives, University Administration intends to create conditions in which institutions can deliver consistent, high-quality outcomes in respect of Equality, Diversity, Anti-Discrimination, with clear lines of accountability.

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Scope and Applicability

This document covers all activities and stakeholders associated with Equality within institutions affiliated to University Administration, together with arrangements for monitoring, review and reporting of outcomes.

The provisions apply to all universities and colleges under University Administration. Sector partners, including employers and professional bodies, are expected to support implementation within their respective spheres.

Key Provisions

The document mandates periodic self-assessment against Equality, disclosure of material information to University Administration, and corrective action where institutional performance falls short of the stated expectations.

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Implementation Arrangements

Implementation will proceed through phased institutional adoption, supported by professional development, shared guidance and a common reporting calendar established by University Administration.

Institutions are expected to appoint a lead authority for implementation, adapt the framework to local context, and report progress to University Administration in line with the prescribed cycle.

Roles and Responsibilities

Clear allocation of responsibility is expected at institutional level, with University Administration acting as the coordinating authority for evaluation, escalation and cross-institutional learning.

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Monitoring and Evaluation

Monitoring covers both compliance and quality, combining documented evidence with stakeholder feedback to build a complete picture of institutional performance over time.

Closing Note

The success of this regulation rests on shared understanding and consistent application. University Administration stands ready to support institutions in implementing Equality and looks forward to reviewing collective progress.